OptionIQ: User Manual

Oct 17, 2026 · @Sunil Jaggi

OptionIQ keeps a log of the options you sell or buy and the stocks you own, in each of your brokerage accounts. It shows your profit and loss, warns you before options expire, and can look for new trade ideas.

You don't need to be a computer or finance expert. Everything below is step by step, and everything stays on your own computer.

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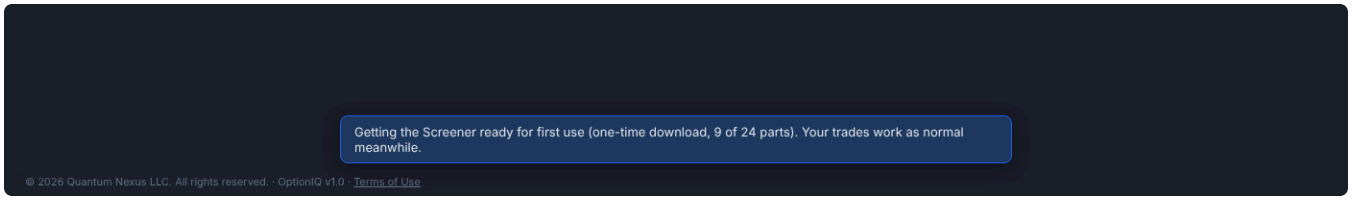
1. Installing the app

You need the file **OptionIQ.zip** and a Windows 10 or 11 computer. Nothing else has to be installed.

Using a Mac? Follow Installing on a Mac below instead of these steps.

1. **Make a new, empty folder** for the app. For example, right-click your Desktop, choose **New → Folder**, and name it `OptionIQ`.
2. **Move the zip file into that folder.**
3. **Right-click the zip file** and choose **Extract All...**.
4. Windows asks where to put the files. It suggests a new folder with the zip's name. **Delete that last part** so the box shows only your new folder, then click **Extract**. (If you leave it, everything ends up one folder deeper. That still works; just remember which folder it's in.)
5. Open the folder. You should see **Start OptionIQ**, **READ ME FIRST**, **README** and a folder called **app**.
6. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.**
   - If a blue box says **"Windows protected your PC"**, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Windows shows this once for programs that come from the internet.
7. The app opens in its own window after a few seconds. To close it, close the window.

The first time only: the app downloads the parts the Screener needs (about 30 MB, usually a minute or two), so be connected to the internet. A blue message at the bottom shows how far along it is. Your trades work as normal meanwhile, and the **Screener**, **Analysis**, **Discover** and **Watchlist** tabs work once it's done. If a red message says the download didn't work, check your internet and click **Try again**.



Desktop icon: the first time OptionIQ starts, it puts an **OptionIQ** icon on your desktop. Double-click that icon to start the app each day. If you delete it, ⚙ **Settings → About** has a button to put it back.

If nothing opens: double-click **Start OptionIQ** once more and wait 10 seconds. The first start can be slow while Windows checks the new files.

Installing on a Mac

On a Mac you need the file **OptionIQ for Mac.zip** instead, and macOS 11 (Big Sur) or newer. It works on Apple-chip (M1, M2, M3 and later) and Intel Macs. Nothing else has to be installed. Everything after this section (setup, buttons, trades, backups) is the same on a Mac.

1. **Put the zip file where you want the app to live**, for example in your **Documents** folder.
2. **Double-click the zip file.** The Mac unzips it into a new folder called **OptionIQ** next to it. Everything the app uses, including your trades, stays in that folder. Open it. You can delete the zip file afterwards.
3. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.command.**
   - **The first time**, the Mac says it can't check the file, because the app doesn't come from the App Store. Click **Done**. Then open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to the line saying **"Start OptionIQ.command" was blocked**, click **Open Anyway**, enter your Mac password if asked, and click **Open Anyway** again.
   - On macOS 14 or earlier you can instead right-click (or Control-click) the file, choose **Open**, then click **Open**.
   - You only do this once.

4. A **Terminal** window opens. **The first time only**, it downloads the app's own copy of Python (about 20 MB, a minute or so). When it says OptionIQ is starting, you can close the Terminal window.
5. The app opens in its own window if **Google Chrome**, **Microsoft Edge** or **Brave** is installed on the Mac. Otherwise it opens in **Safari**. The Screener's one-time download (step 6 above) then happens just as on Windows.
6. **To close it**, press ⌘ **Command + Q** in its window, or close its Safari tab.

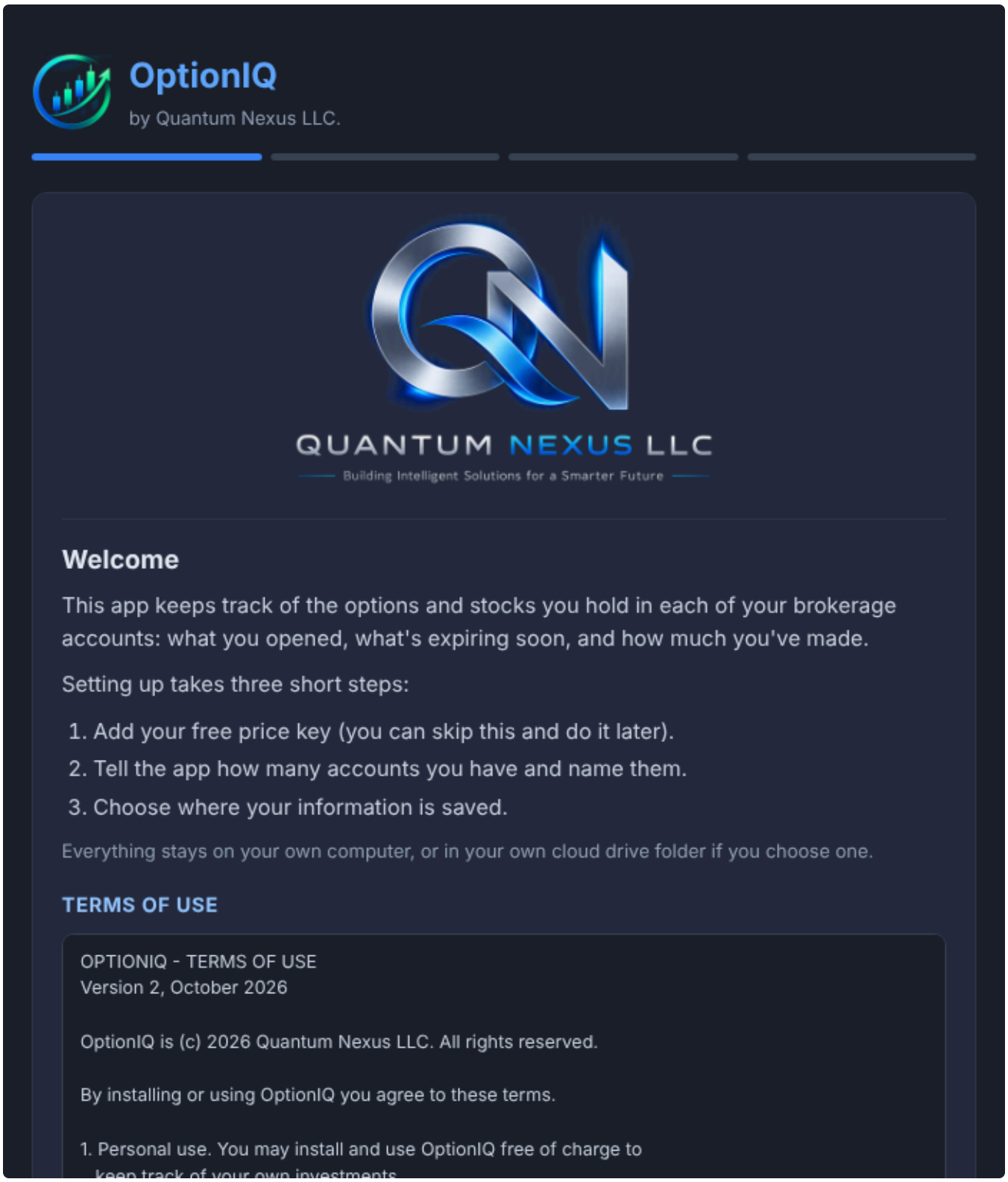
Tip: drag **Start OptionIQ.command** to the right-hand end of your Dock to start it faster next time.

On a Mac, OptionIQ also puts an **OptionIQ** icon on your desktop the first time it starts. Double-click it to start the app without a Terminal window.

The sample file **OptionIQ Sample Import** (section 6) works the same on a Mac.

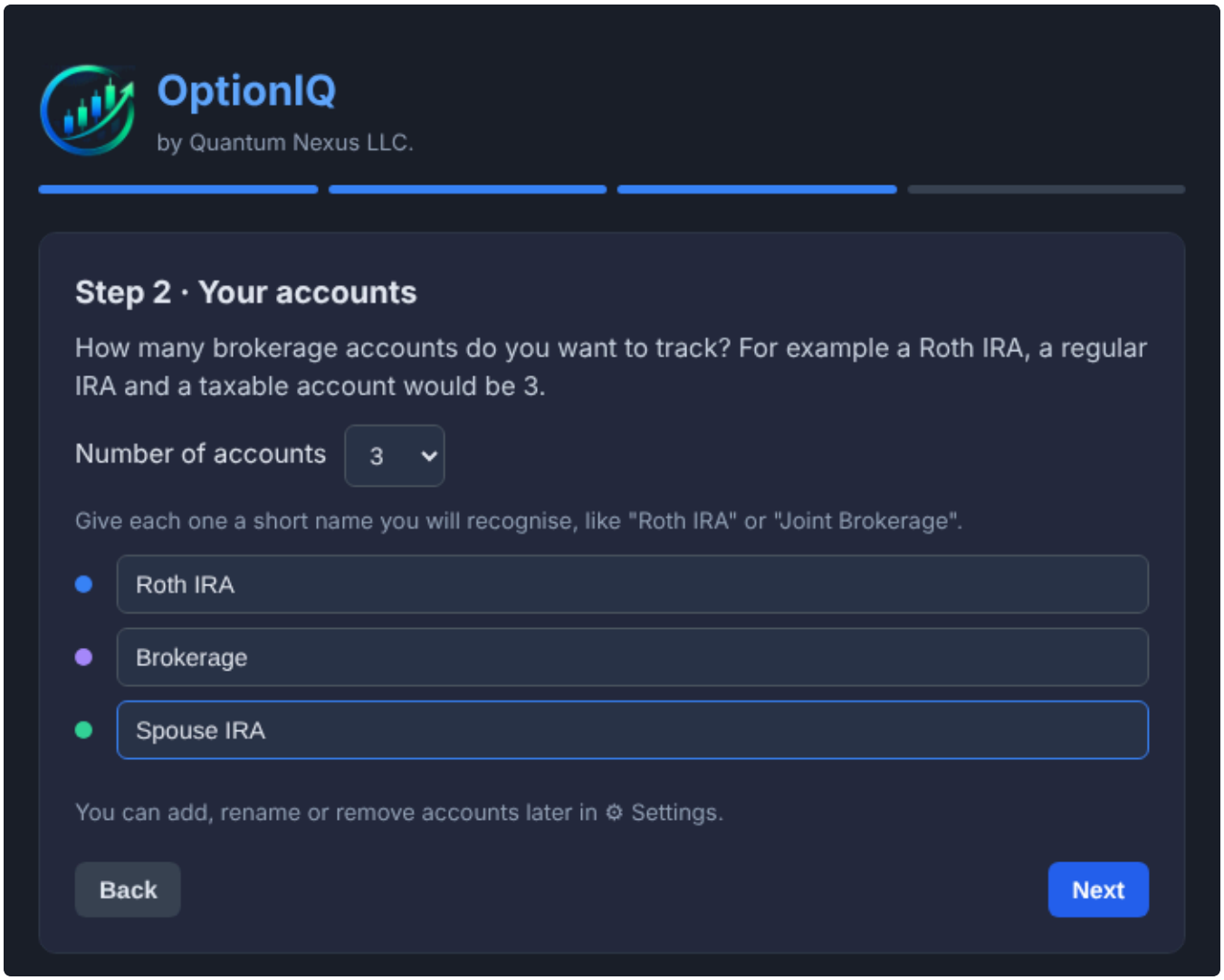
2. First-time setup

The first time it opens, the app shows its Terms of Use. Read them, tick "I have read and agree to the Terms of Use" and click Get started. Then it asks three short questions. You can change every answer later in ⚙ **Settings**.



1. **Your free price key.** Paste your Finnhub key and click **Test key**, or click **Next (or skip for now)** and add it later. Section 3 shows how to get one.

2. **Your accounts.** Pick how many brokerage accounts you have (1 to 10) and type a short name for each, such as "Roth IRA" or "Joint Brokerage". Each account gets its own colour.
3. **Where to keep your information.** Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)** so everything stays together. Click **Start using the app**.



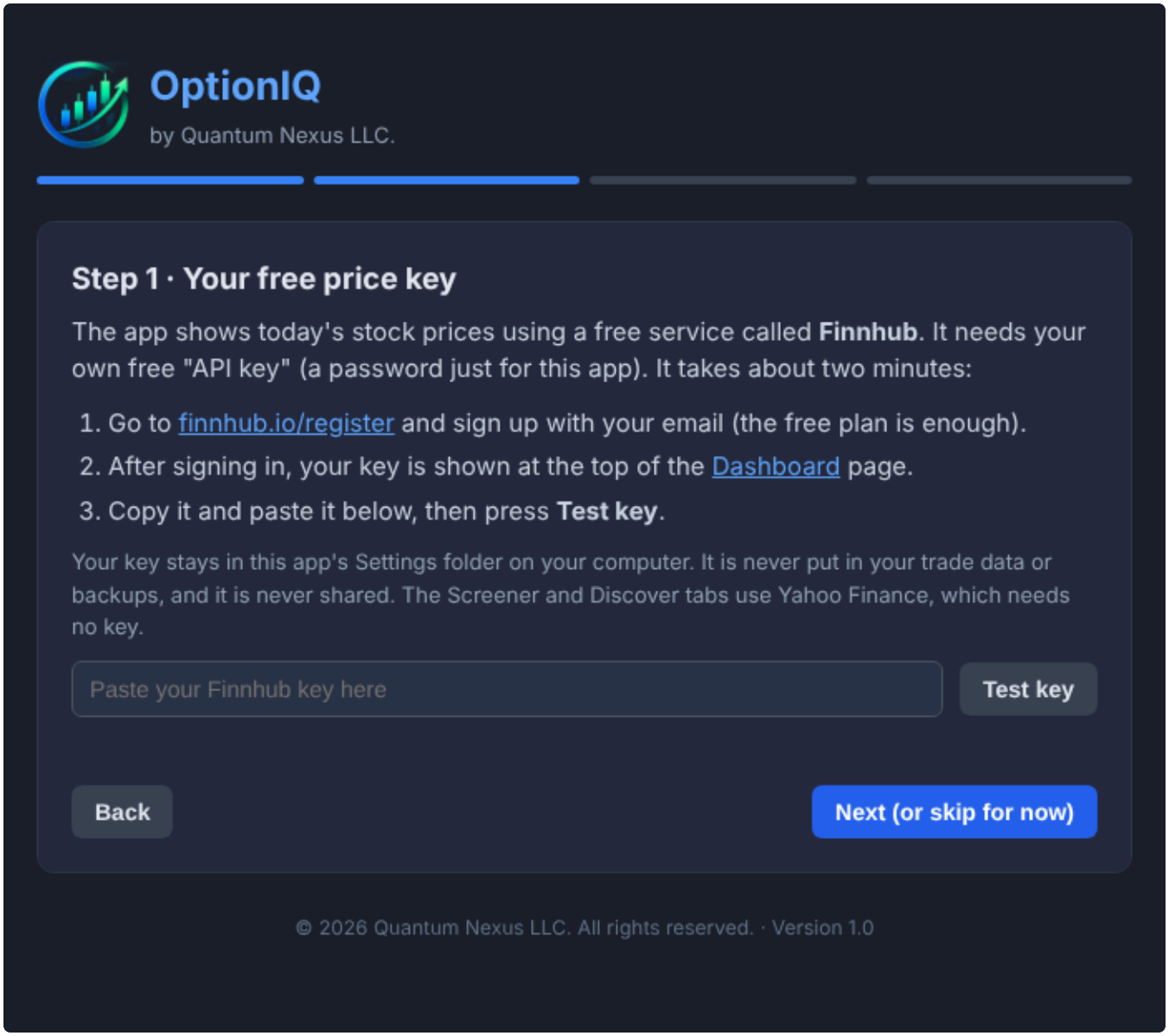
Already used the browser version (Options Trade Logger)? After setup, click 📂 **Load Data** and pick your backup file. Section 6 explains.

3. Getting your free price key

A key (an "API key") is like a password that lets the app fetch today's stock prices for you from a free service called **Finnhub**. The 🔄 **Prices** and 🏔️ **Check ATH** buttons need it. The Screener, Analysis, Discover and Watchlist use Yahoo Finance, which needs no key.

Everyone gets their own key, free. Never share yours or use someone else's. The app never comes with a key in it.

1. In your web browser, go to finnhub.io/register.
2. Enter your email and a password, then click **Sign up**. If Finnhub emails you, click the link in that email to confirm.
3. Sign in. On your **Dashboard**, near the top, is **API Key** followed by a long line of letters and numbers.
4. Select that line with your mouse, right-click and choose **Copy**.
5. In the app, paste it into the key box (in setup, or ⚙ **Settings → Price key**) and click **Test key**.

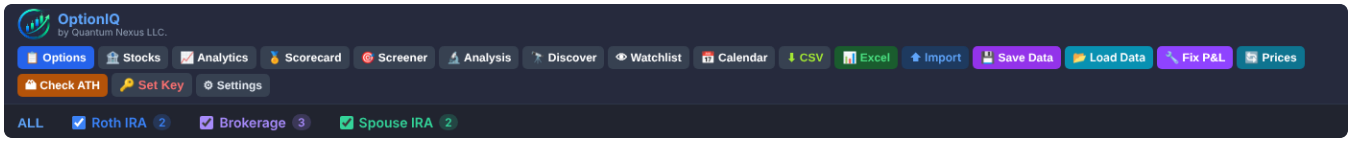


What the app says	What to do
The key works	Nothing. It's saved.
Finnhub didn't accept that key	It was only partly copied. Copy and paste it again.
Couldn't reach Finnhub	Check your internet connection and try again.

The free plan is enough; you never enter payment details. Your key is kept only in the app's **Settings** folder, never in your trades or backups. To remove it: ⚙ **Settings → Price key → Remove key**.

4. The buttons along the top

The first group of buttons switches between screens; the button for the screen you're on is lit up. The second group does something right away.

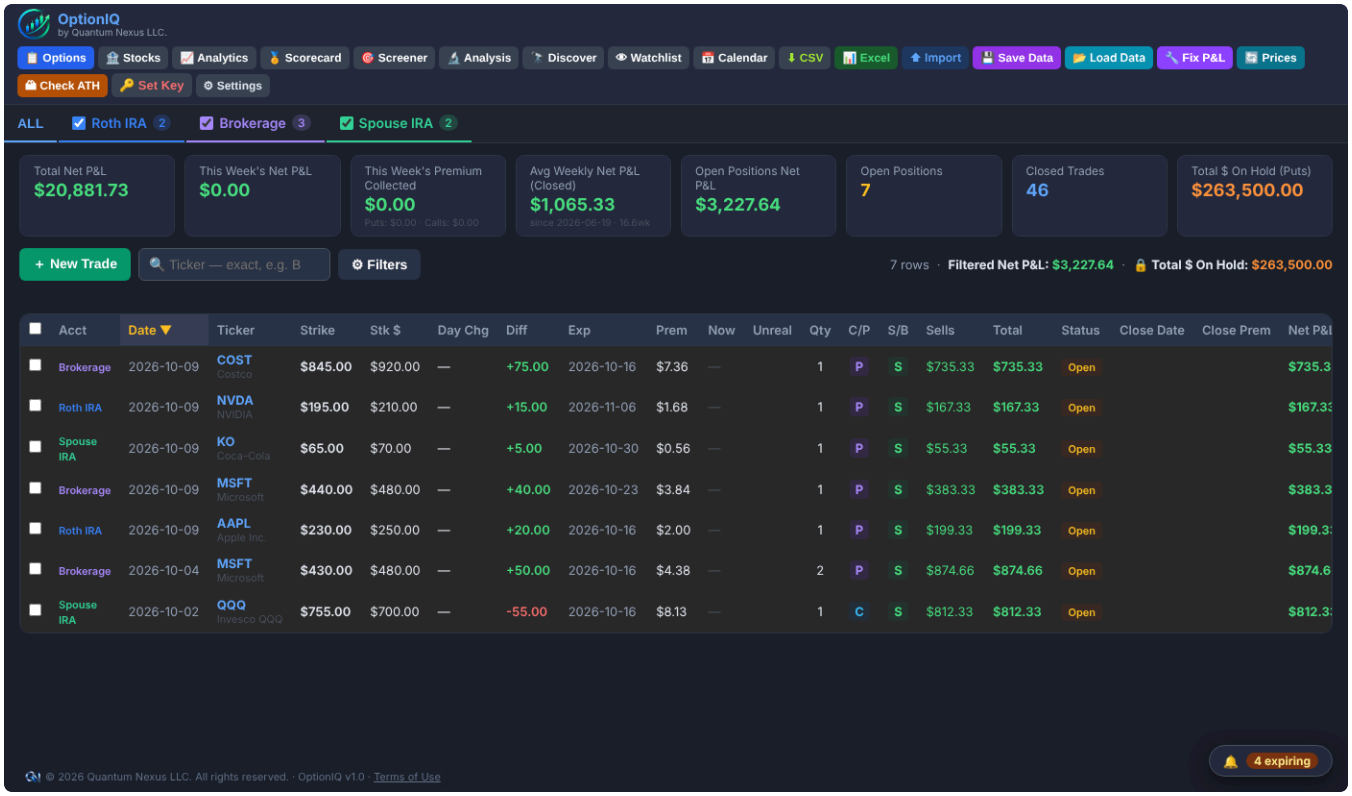


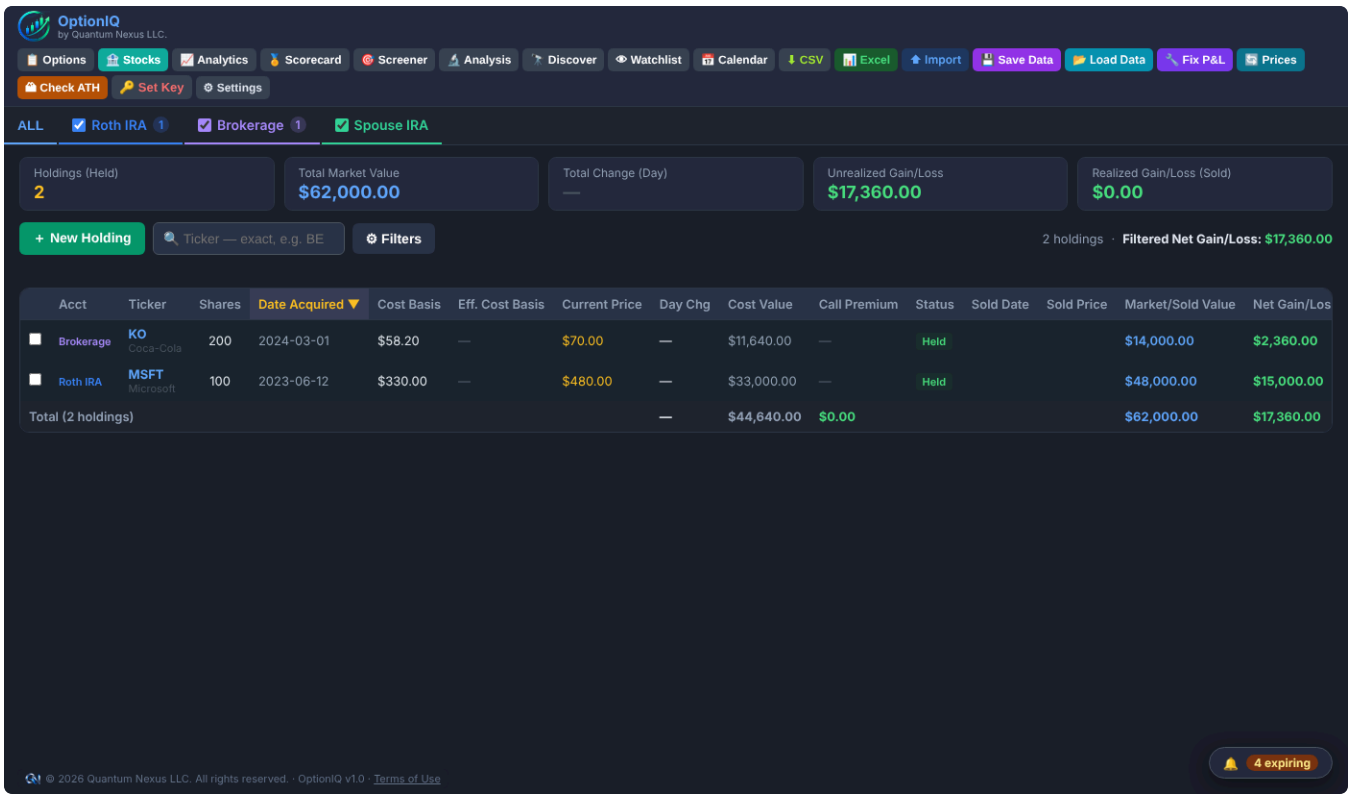
Screens

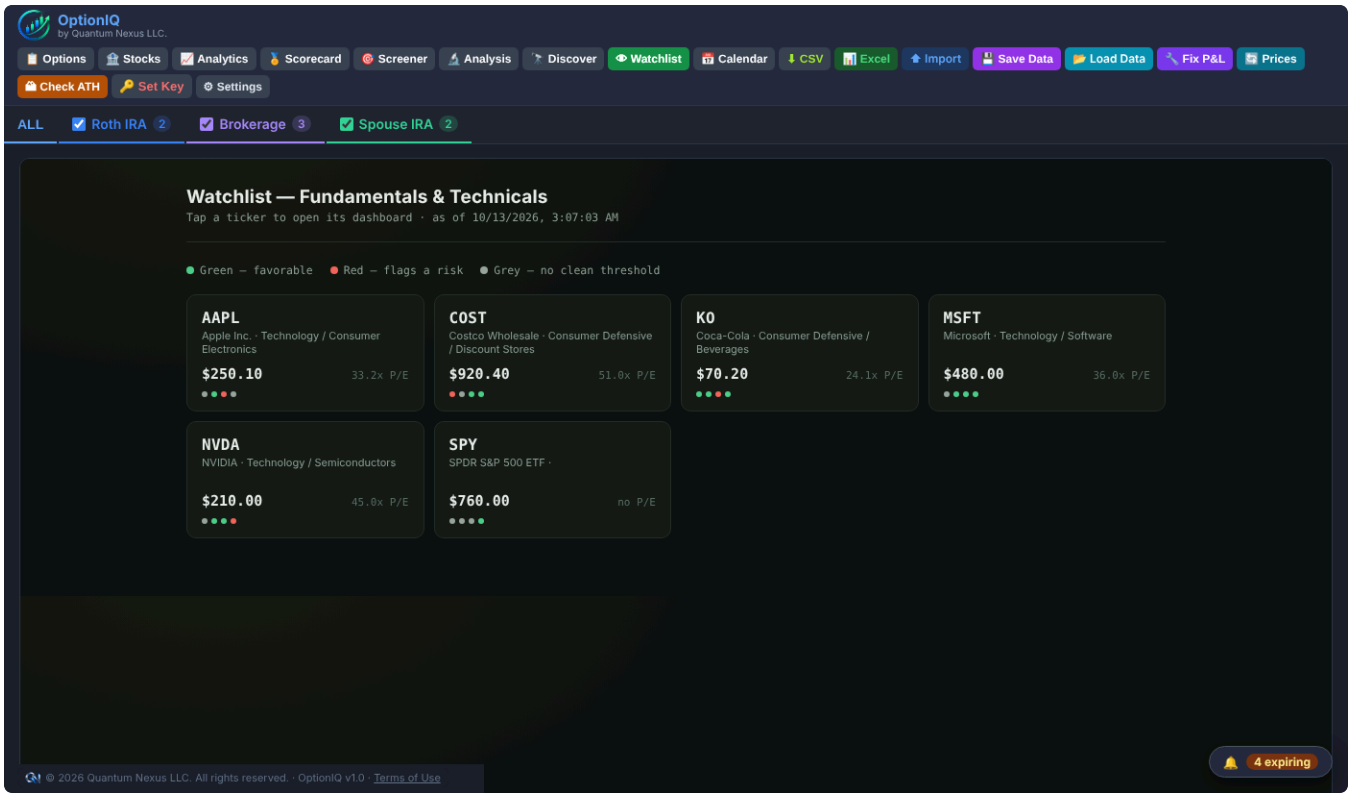
Button	What you see
📋 Options	Every option trade, newest first, with totals at the top (total profit, this week's profit, open positions, money set aside for puts). **+ New Trade** adds one; **Filters** narrows the list.
🏦 Stocks	The shares you own: what you paid, what they're worth now, and your gain or loss.
📈 Analytics	Charts of your profit over time, by week, by account and by ticker.
🏅 Scorecard	How each strategy, ticker and account has actually performed: win rate, average return and more.

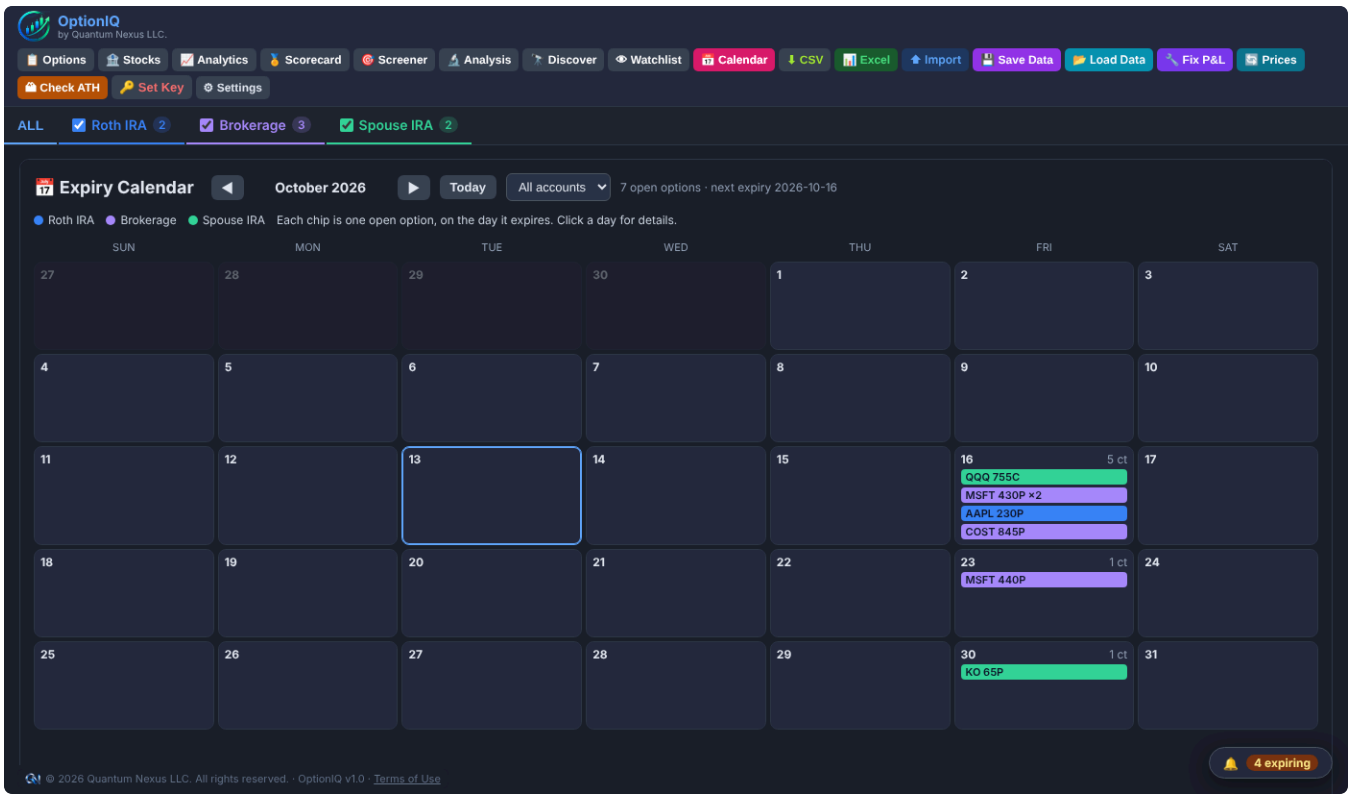
Button	What you see
🎯 Screener	Looks for new put and covered-call ideas on the tickers in your watchlist. Click **Run Screen**; **Criteria** sets the rules. Weekly and Monthly fill them in for you, and 🔁 Roll candidates suggests rolls for options you hold. See section 6.
🔬 Analysis	Fundamentals and price trends for everything you hold or watch.
🔭 Discover	Scans the whole S&P 500 for new candidates you aren't watching yet.
👁️ Watchlist	A card for each ticker you watch or hold, with green / red / grey dots for value, profit, debt and how jumpy the stock is. Click a card for the details.
📅 Calendar	A month calendar with each open option on the day it expires, coloured by account. Click a day to see its trades.

What the main screens look like (the pictures use made-up practice trades):




OptionIQ
by Quantum Nexus LLC.
Options
Stocks
Analytics
Scorecard
Screener
Analysis
Discover
Watchlist
Calendar
CSV
Excel
Import
Save Data
Load Data
Fix P&L
Prices
Check ATH
Set Key
Settings
ALL
Roth IRA 1
Brokerage 1
Spouse IRA
Holdings (Held)
2
Total Market Value
$62,000.00
Total Change (Day)
—
Unrealized Gain/Loss
$17,360.00
Realized Gain/Loss (Sold)
$0.00
+ New Holding
Ticker — exact, e.g. BE
Filters
2 holdings · Filtered Net Gain/Loss: $17,360.00
Acct
Ticker
Shares
Date Acquired
Cost Basis
Eff. Cost Basis
Current Price
Day Chg
Cost Value
Call Premium
Status
Sold Date
Sold Price
Market/Sold Value
Net Gain/Los
Brokerage
KO
Coca-Cola
200
2024-03-01
$58.20
—
$70.00
—
$11,640.00
—
Held
$14,000.00
$2,360.00
Roth IRA
MSFT
Microsoft
100
2023-06-12
$330.00
—
$480.00
—
$33,000.00
—
Held
$48,000.00
$15,000.00
Total (2 holdings)
—
$44,640.00
$0.00
$62,000.00
$17,360.00
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4 expiring


OptionIQ
by Quantum Nexus LLC.
Options
Stocks
Analytics
Scorecard
Screener
Analysis
Discover
Watchlist
Calendar
CSV
Excel
Import
Save Data
Load Data
Fix P&L
Prices
Check ATH
Set Key
Settings
ALL
Roth IRA 2
Brokerage 3
Spouse IRA 2
Watchlist — Fundamentals & Technicals
Tap a ticker to open its dashboard · as of 10/13/2026, 3:07:03 AM
Green — favorable
Red — flags a risk
Grey — no clean threshold
AAPL
Apple Inc. · Technology / Consumer Electronics
$250.10
33.2x P/E
COST
Costco Wholesale · Consumer Defensive / Discount Stores
$920.40
51.0x P/E
KO
Coca-Cola · Consumer Defensive / Beverages
$70.20
24.1x P/E
MSFT
Microsoft · Technology / Software
$480.00
36.0x P/E
NVDA
NVIDIA · Technology / Semiconductors
$210.00
45.0x P/E
SPY
SPDR S&P 500 ETF ·
$760.00
no P/E
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4 expiring



Actions

Button	What it does
⬇ CSV	Saves your trades as a spreadsheet file (opens in Excel). It asks which trades: 1. all trades, open and closed; 2. open trades only; or 3. what is on screen now.
📊 Excel	Saves a formatted Excel workbook with a sheet per account.
⬆ Import	Brings in past option trades from an Excel file (.xlsx) or a spreadsheet saved as CSV. Open and closed trades both come in. It reads the sample file or a file made by ⬇ CSV (section 6, Bring in past trades).
💾 Save Data	Makes a backup of everything right now (section 6).
📂 Load Data	Brings in a backup file made by 💾 Save Data: trades, stocks and watchlist (section 6).

Button	What it does
🔧 Fix P&L	Recalculates the profit and loss on every trade. Use it if a total looks wrong.
🔄 Prices	Fetches the latest stock prices (needs your price key).
🏔️ Check ATH	Checks whether the S&P 500 (SPY) or Nasdaq (QQQ) hit a new all-time high (needs your price key).
🔑 Set Key	A quick way to enter or change your price key.
⚙ Settings	Accounts, backups, reminders, price key and where your information is kept (section 5).

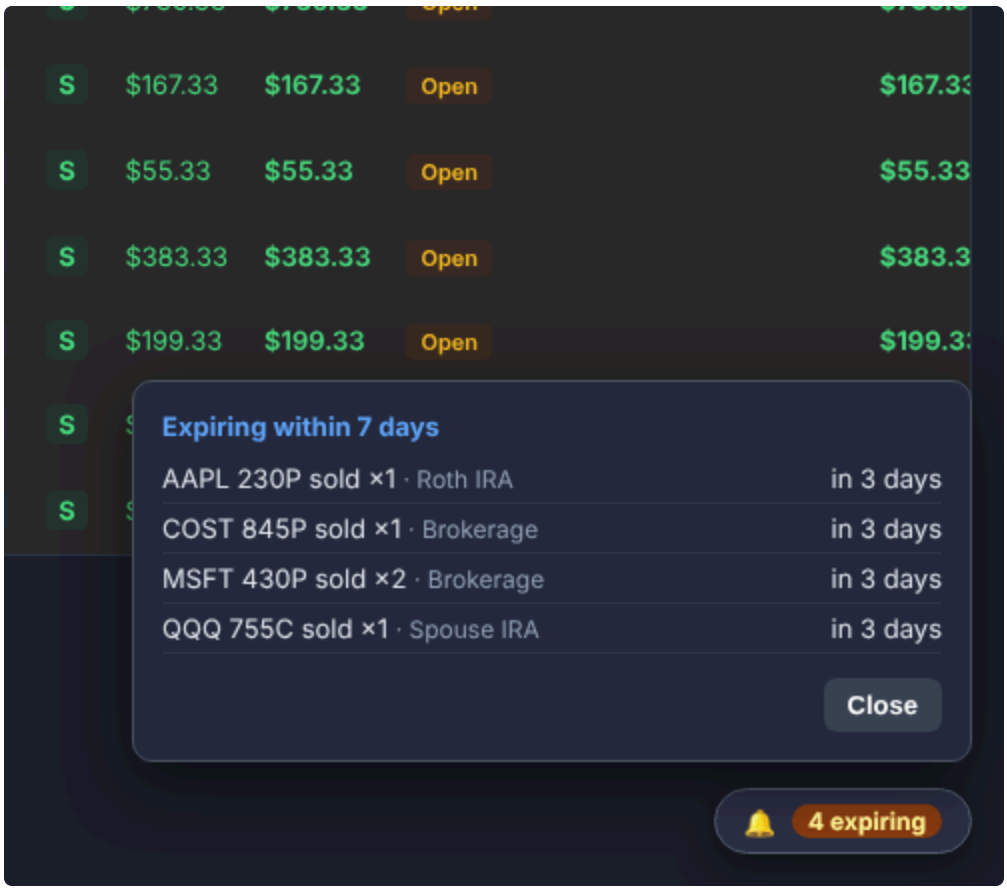
Exports from ⬇ CSV and 📊 Excel are saved in **My Data → Exports** inside your app folder.

5. Account tabs, reminders and Settings

Account tabs. Under the buttons is a coloured tab for each account, with the number of open positions beside it. Tick or untick an account to show or hide it; click **ALL** to see every account together.

The 🔔 reminder button. It sits in the bottom-right corner whenever something needs your attention. Click it to see the list.

- **"expiring"**: open options that expire within 7 days (you can change the number of days).
- **"past expiry"**: options whose expiry date has passed but are still marked Open. The app never changes them on its own; close or roll them yourself when you're ready.
- **"Backup due"**: your last backup is more than a week old. Click 💾 **Back up now** right there.

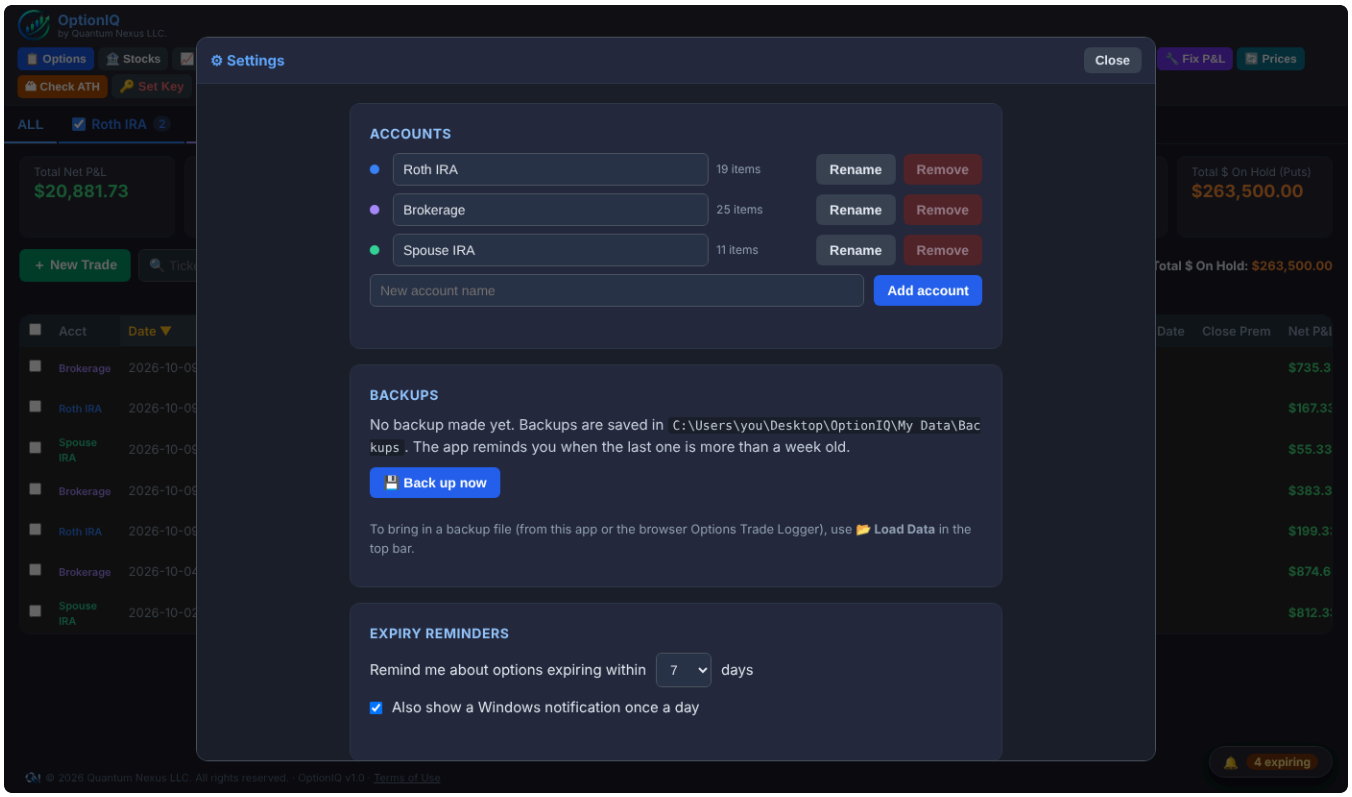


While the app is open, Windows (or your Mac) also shows a small pop-up once a day about options expiring soon.

⚙ **Settings** opens a window with six parts. Click **Close** at the top right when done.

Part	What you can do
Accounts	Rename an account (its trades follow the new name), add a new one, or remove one that has no trades.
Backups	See when you last backed up, and back up now.
Expiry reminders	Choose how many days ahead to be reminded, and turn the Windows (or Mac) pop-up on or off.
Price key	Paste, test or remove your Finnhub key.
Where your information is kept	Move your information to another folder, for example a OneDrive or Google Drive folder.

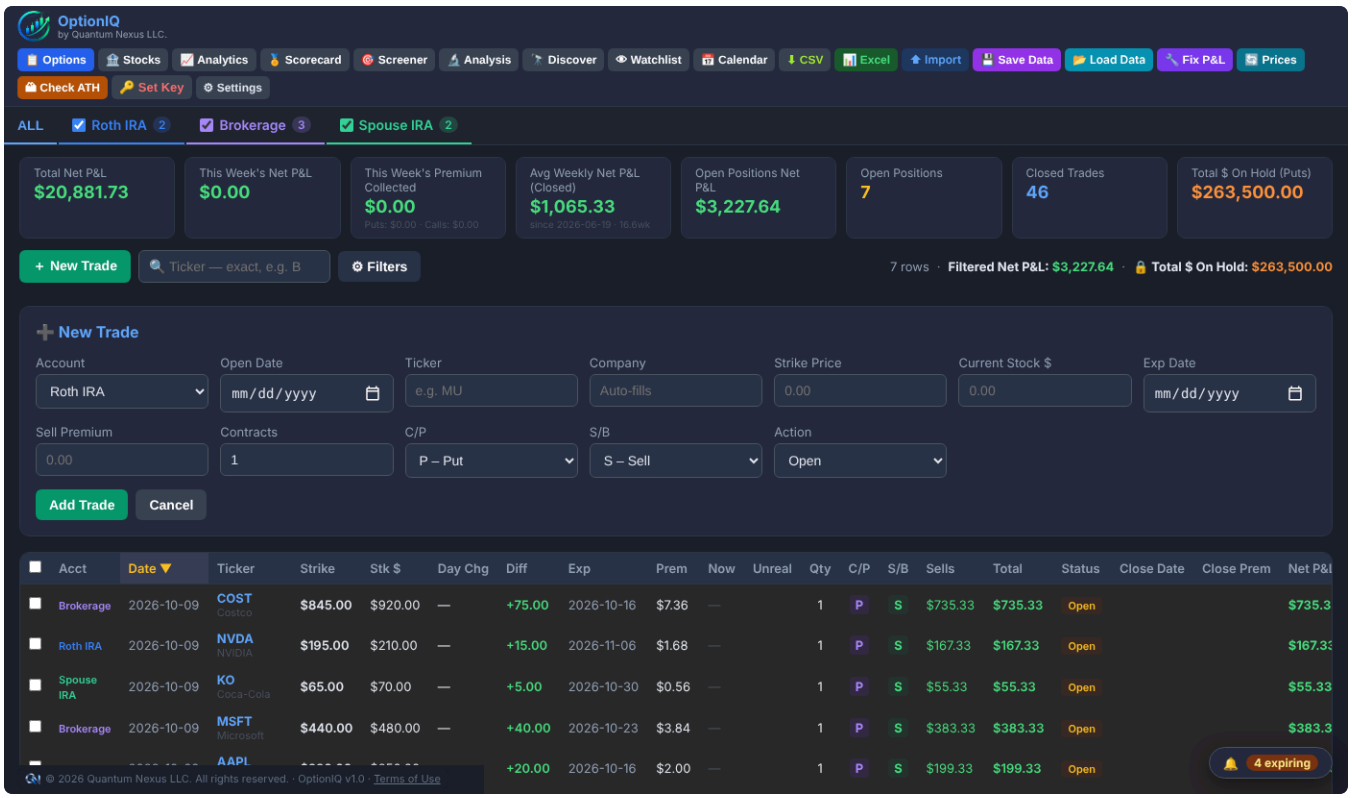
Part	What you can do
About	See which version you have, and click Check for updates to look for a new one right away (section 7). If the OptionIQ icon is missing from your desktop, click Put the OptionIQ icon on my desktop.



6. Everyday tasks

Log a new option trade

1. On 📋 **Options**, click **+ New Trade**.
2. Pick the account, type the ticker (for example AAPL), the strike price, the expiry date, the premium per share and the number of contracts.
3. Choose **P** (put) or **C** (call), and **S** (you sold it) or **B** (you bought it). Leave Action as **Open**.
4. Click **Add Trade**.



Close an option (it expired, was assigned, called away, bought back or rolled)

1. Find the trade in the list and click its ✏️ (edit) button at the right end of the row.
2. Change Action from **Open** to what happened: **Expired**, **Assigned**, **Called Away**, **Bought to Close**, **Sold to Close** or **Rolled**.
3. Fill in the close date and, if you paid or received money to close, the close premium. Click **Save Changes**. The profit is worked out for you.
4. Rolled it? Also log the new option as a new trade.

Add stocks you own: on 🏦 **Stocks**, click **+ New Holding**. Use **Buy More** or **Sell** on a holding when you add to it or sell it.

Back up (do this every week or so)

1. Click 💾 **Save Data**. A message shows where the backup was saved: **My Data → Backups**, in a file named with today's date. The newest 30 are kept.
2. To be extra safe, copy that file to a USB stick, email it to yourself, or keep your app folder in OneDrive or Google Drive.

Load a backup, or move over from the browser version (Options Trade Logger)

1. Click 📂 **Load Data** and pick the backup file (for example `options_trades_backup_2026-09-21.json`).

2. Your trades, stocks and watchlist come in exactly as they were. Any account name in the file that you haven't set up is added for you; rename it in ⚙ **Settings** if you like.

Import or Load Data: which one? Both bring trades into OptionIQ, but they take different files and work differently.

	📂 Load Data	⬆ Import
File it takes	The .json backup made by 💾 Save Data	A spreadsheet saved as .csv (or .txt, .tsv)
What comes in	Option trades, stocks and watchlist	Option trades only
Pressing OK	Adds only what you don't already have	Adds every row, even trades you already have
Pressing Cancel	Replaces all your data with the backup	Replaces all your option trades with the file
Account names you haven't set up	Added as new accounts	Lists them and asks first: OK creates them, Cancel stops so you can fix the spelling
Use it for	Restoring a backup, or moving to a new computer	Bringing in past trades from a spreadsheet

In both pop-ups, **Cancel does not mean stop. It means replace everything.** To add trades, press **OK**. Press 💾 Save Data first, so you can go back if something looks wrong.

Bring in past trades (instead of typing them one by one)

1. Open **OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx** in Excel (on a Mac, Numbers or Excel). It holds 8 made-up trades: 6 closed and 2 still open. If you don't have the file, copy the sample below into Notepad (on a Mac, TextEdit, after choosing Format → Make Plain Text) and save it with a name ending in .csv.
2. Delete the sample rows but keep the first row of headings. Then type one row per trade, using the column guide below.
3. Save it. In Excel, a plain Save is fine, because Import reads Excel files too. You can also save it as CSV: **File → Save As**, then choose **CSV (Comma delimited)**.
   On a Mac in **Numbers**, don't just press Save, because that makes a Numbers file the app can't read. Use **File → Export To → CSV**, click **Save**, and pick where to put it. In Excel on a Mac, use **File → Save As** and choose **CSV UTF-8**.

4. In OptionIQ, click ⬆ **Import**, pick the file and press **OK** to add the trades.
5. Check the trades on the 📋 Options screen. Importing the same file twice gives you every trade twice.

```
Account,Date,Company,Ticker,Strike,Current Stock,Exp
Date,Prem,Qty,C/P,S/B,Sells,Total,Action,Close Date,Close Prem,Net P&L
Roth IRA,2026-08-03,Apple,AAPL,210,218.50,2026-08-
15,1.25,1,P,S,,,Expired,2026-08-15,0,
Brokerage,2026-08-05,Microsoft,MSFT,420,410.00,2026-08-29,3.10,2,C,S,,,Bought
to Close,2026-08-20,-150,
Roth IRA,2026-08-10,Nvidia,NVDA,120,125.00,2026-08-
22,1.80,1,P,S,,,Assigned,2026-08-22,,
Brokerage,2026-08-25,Nvidia,NVDA,125,121.00,2026-09-05,1.40,1,C,S,,,Called
Away,2026-09-05,,
Brokerage,2026-09-02,AMD,AMD,160,155.00,2026-10-17,2.50,1,C,B,,,Sold to
Close,2026-09-24,380,
Roth IRA,2026-09-08,Walmart,WMT,95,97.00,2026-09-19,0.80,3,P,S,,,Rolled,2026-
09-18,-120,
Roth IRA,2026-10-06,Coca-Cola,KO,68,70.20,2026-11-20,0.95,2,P,S,,,Open,,,
Brokerage,2026-10-08,Costco,COST,980,955.00,2026-12-18,12.40,1,C,S,,,Open,,,
```

Column	What to type	Example
Account	One of your account names, spelled as in ⚙ Settings (capitals don't matter). A name OptionIQ doesn't have yet is listed, and you choose whether to create it. A blank name goes into your first account.	Roth IRA
Date	The day you opened the trade	2026-08-03 or 8/3/2026
Company	The company name (optional)	Apple
Ticker	The stock symbol	AAPL
Strike	The strike price	210
Current Stock	The stock price when you traded (optional)	218.50
Exp Date	The expiry date	2026-08-15
Prem	The premium per share	1.25

Column	What to type	Example
Qty	The number of contracts	1
C/P	C for a call, P for a put	P
S/B	S if you sold the option, B if you bought it	S
Sells, Total	Leave empty. The app works these out.	
Action	Open, Expired, Assigned, Called Away, Bought to Close, Sold to Close or Rolled	Expired
Close Date	The day the trade ended. Leave empty for an open trade.	2026-08-15
Close Prem	Dollars for closing all contracts: minus if you paid, plus if you received. 0 or empty if it expired, was assigned or called away.	-150
Net P&L	Leave empty. The app works it out.	

An **open trade** has Action set to Open, with Close Date and Close Prem left empty. For a **rolled trade**, enter the old option as Rolled with what you paid to buy it back, then the new option as its own Open row.

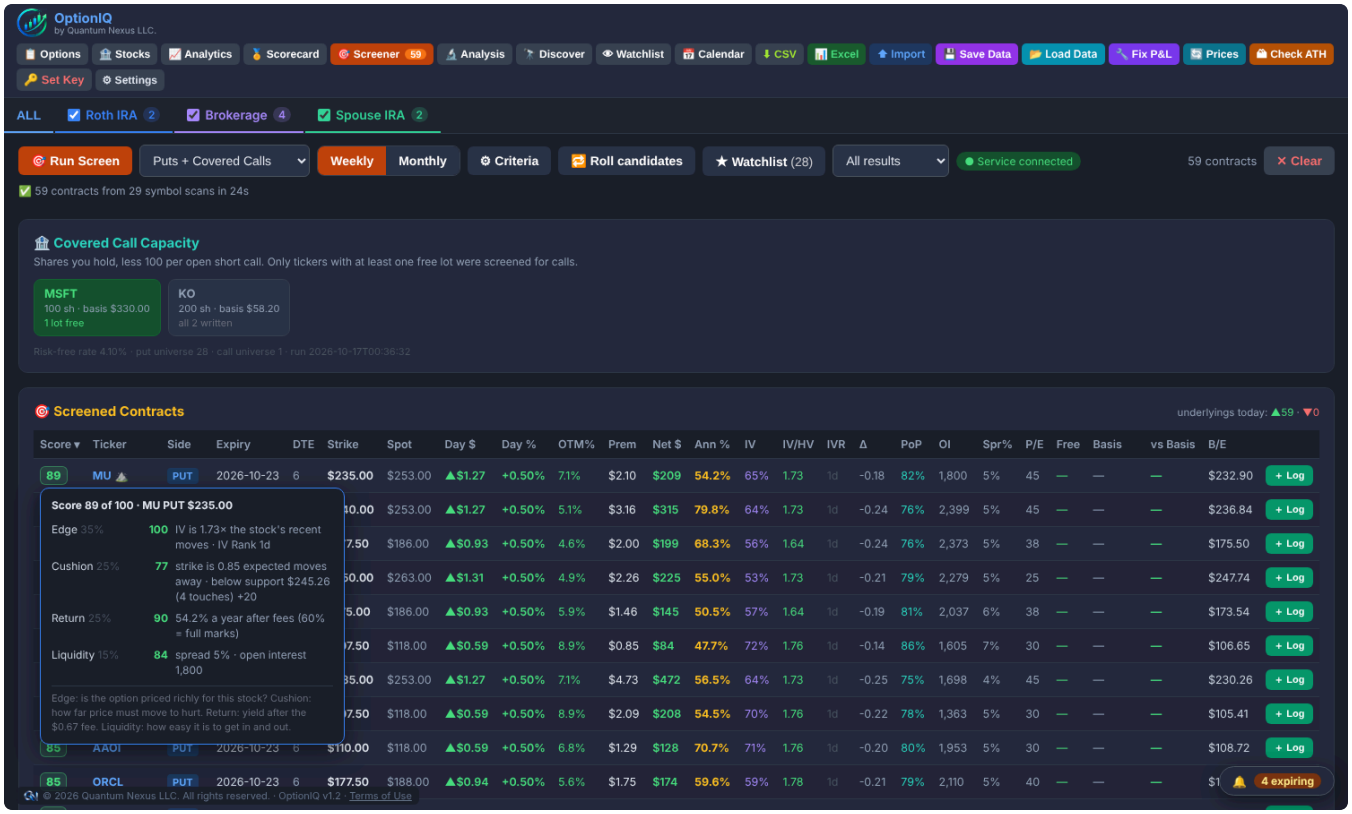
You can also import a file made by ⬇ **CSV**, for example to copy trades into another copy of OptionIQ. ⬇ CSV asks which trades to save; pick 1. All trades to copy your full history. The app finds each column by its heading, so the columns can be in any order. Stocks and the watchlist are not in a CSV file; for those, use 💾 Save Data and 📂 Load Data.

Find new trades with the 🎯 Screener

1. Click **Weekly** (expiring in 4 to 14 days, lower risk) or **Monthly** (21 to 45 days). Each fills in sensible rules; ⚙ **Criteria** lets you change any of them.
2. Click **Run Screen**. The best ideas come first, sorted by **Score**.
3. Hover over a Score to see why it got that number. Click **+ Log** on a row to record the trade.

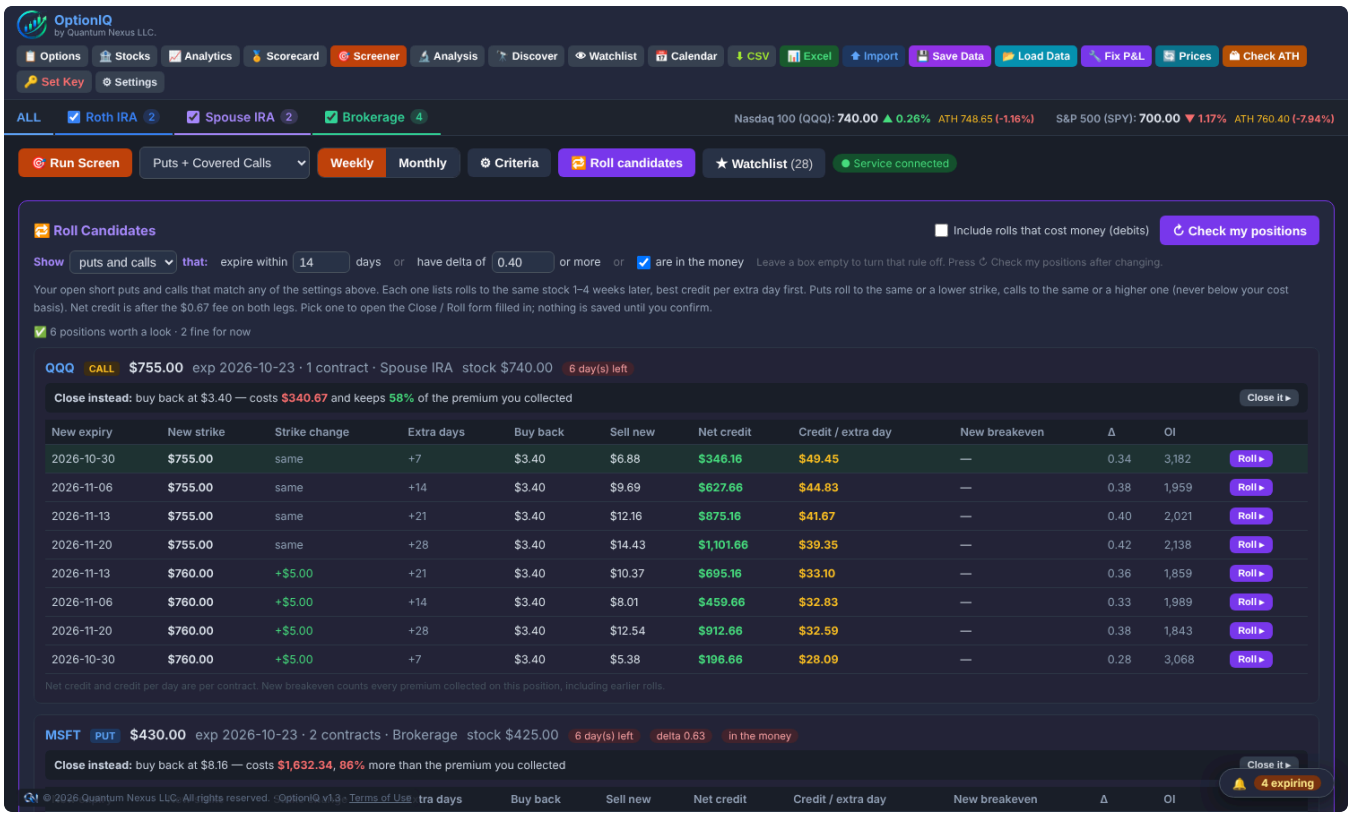
The Score runs from 0 to 100 and adds up four things: whether the option is priced richly for this stock (35%), how far the price must move before it hurts (25%), the yearly return after the $0.67 fee (25%), and how easy it is to get in and out (15%). **Net $** is the premium after the fee. Small signs next to a ticker warn of a dividend before expiry (💲), too much of your money in one sector (⚖), or a price level the stock has bounced off before (⛰).

The **IVR** column needs about 60 days of price history, which the app collects by itself while it is open. Until then it shows how many days it has, and the Score leaves it out.



Roll an option that is close to expiry or in trouble

1. On the 🎯 Screener, click 🔁 **Roll candidates**.
2. Choose which positions to look at: puts, calls or both, and those that expire within a number of days, have a delta at or above a number, or are in the money. A position shows if it matches any rule you've turned on. Leave a box empty, or untick in the money, to turn that rule off.
3. Click **↻ Check my positions**. Each position lists rolls to the same stock 1 to 4 weeks later, the best credit per extra day first. **Close instead** shows what buying it back would cost.
4. Click **Roll ▸** or **Close it ▸** to open the close form already filled in. Nothing is saved until you confirm.



7. Your information, and if something goes wrong

Everything stays inside your app folder: **My Data** holds your trades, backups and exports; **Settings** holds your choices and your price key. Nothing is sent anywhere except ticker symbols when the app looks up prices, and a once-a-day check for a new version of the app. To move the app or copy it to a new computer, move or copy the whole folder.

New versions

When a new version of OptionIQ is ready, a green note appears at the top right a few seconds after you start the app, for example "OptionIQ 1.2 is available", with a short list of what's new. The app looks for new versions once a day. To look right now, open ⚙ **Settings → About** and click **Check for updates**.

1. Click **Update now**, then **OK**.
2. The app first makes a backup of your information, then downloads the new version. The note shows how far along it is.
3. The app closes and opens again by itself, in the same folder. The line at the bottom of the screen shows the new version number.

Your trades, stocks, settings and price key stay exactly as they were, and you don't have to choose any folder. Click **Later** to hide the note; it comes back the next time you start the app.

If the update can't finish (for example, the internet drops), the note turns red and nothing is changed. Click **Try again**, or **Download it myself** to get the new zip file and extract it over your app folder. On Windows, choose **Replace** when it asks about files that already exist. On a Mac, move your **My Data** and **Settings** folders into the new OptionIQ folder.

Problem	What to do
Nothing opens when I double-click Start OptionIQ	Check there is an **app** folder next to it, and that the unzipping had completely finished before you started it (section 1). Then try again. If it still won't start, send the file OptionIQ startup error.txt from the app folder to whoever shared the app with you.
A blue "Windows protected your PC" box	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
Mac: "Start OptionIQ.command" can't be opened	Open System Settings → Privacy & Security, scroll down and click Open Anyway (see Installing on a Mac, step 3).
The Screener says the service isn't connected	Close the app and start it again; the Screener starts with it and needs a few seconds.
Prices don't update	Check your internet, then ⚙ **Settings → Price key → Test key**.
A total looks wrong	Click 🔧 **Fix P&L**.
Something else	Send the files **tracker.log** and **screener.log** (on a Mac also start.log) from the **Settings** folder to whoever shared the app with you. They hold no trades and no keys.

Terms of Use. The full terms are in the file **TERMS OF USE.txt** in your app folder, and the **Terms of Use** link at the bottom of every screen shows them. In short: the app belongs to Quantum Nexus LLC.; you may use it free for your own investments; it is a record-keeping tool, not financial advice.